

# MOVIE STUDIO STRATEGY

*Genre Returns, International Reach & Studio Benchmarks*

An exploratory data analysis of box office, budget, studio, and audience-rating data

# Overview

1

## Business Understanding

Three questions the studio needs answered

2

## Data Understanding & Cleaning

Sources, ERD, and how the data was prepared

3

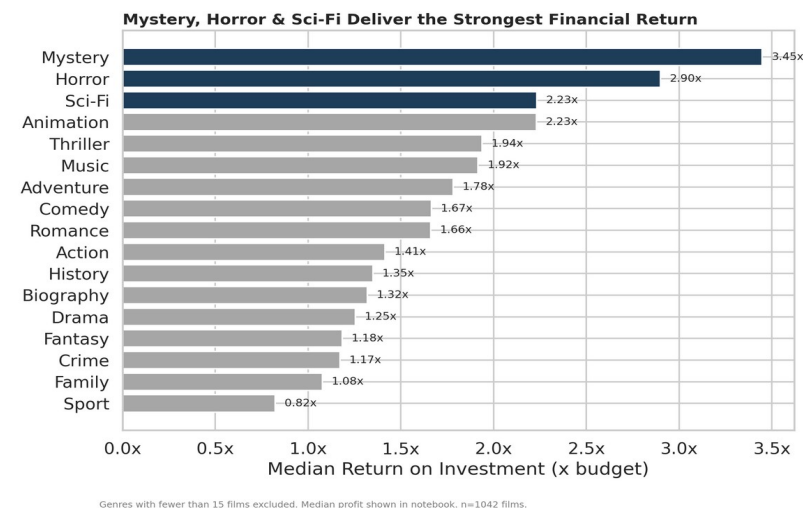
## Three Key Findings

Genre return, international reach, and studio alignment

4

## Recommendations & Next Steps

What the studio should greenlight first



1,042

major theatrical releases analyzed, with studio + international gross data

# Business Understanding

## THE STAKEHOLDER

The head of our company's brand-new movie studio division.

*Before spending a dollar on production, leadership needs an evidence-based answer to three questions:*

1

Which genres deliver the best financial return? (ROI & median profit)

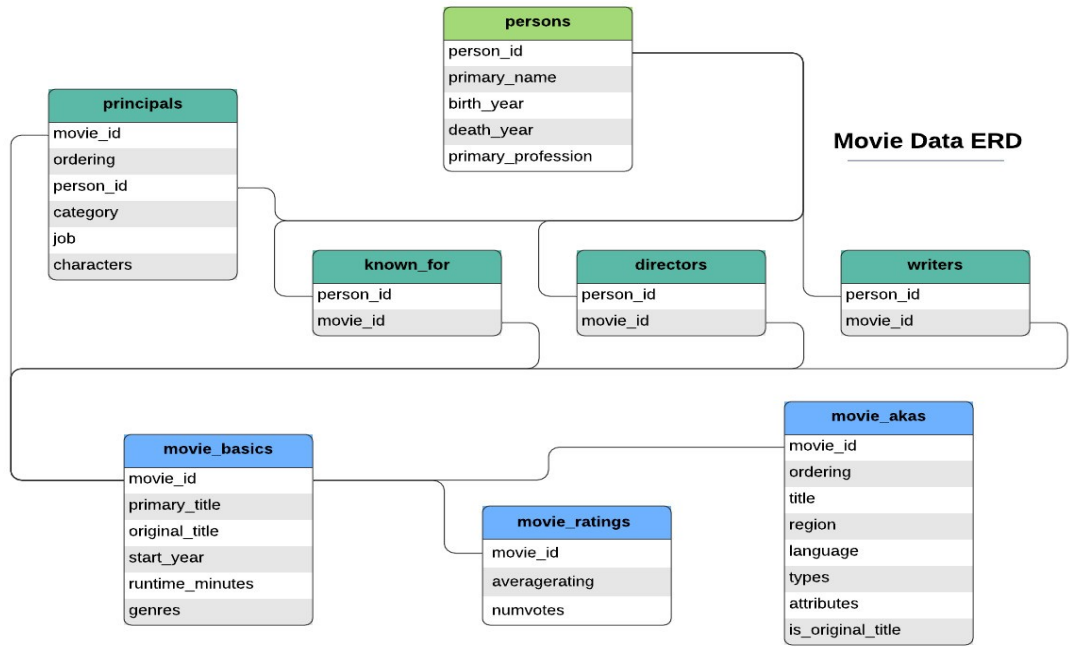
2

Which genres do best with an international audience?

3

Which studios perform best, and do they align with the top genres?

# What We Used, and How We Cleaned It



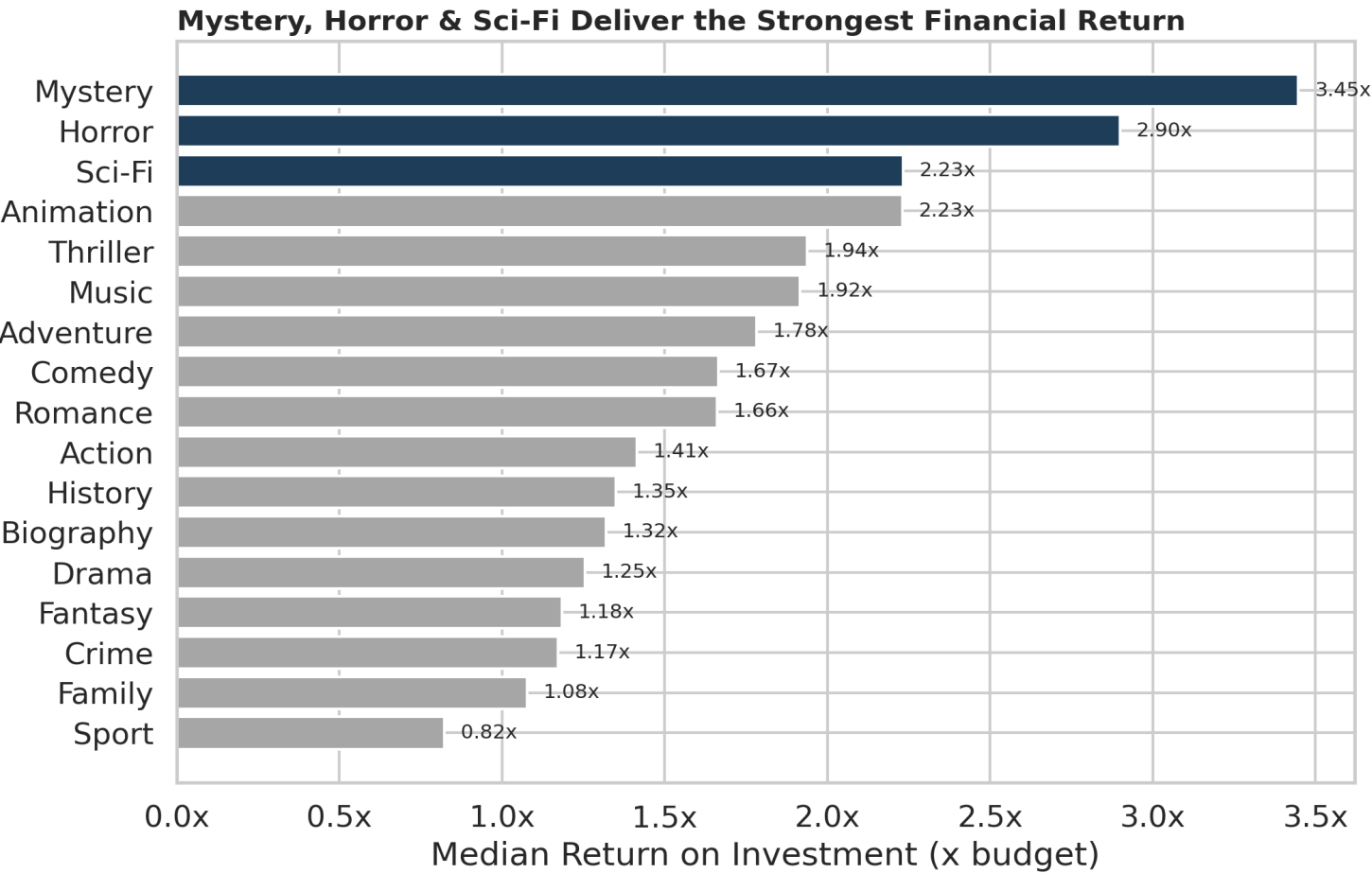
IMDB entity-relationship diagram (movie\_basics + movie\_ratings tables used)

|                 |                                  |
|-----------------|----------------------------------|
| The Numbers     | Budget, domestic/worldwide gross |
| Box Office Mojo | Studio, foreign gross            |
| IMDB            | Genre(s), rating                 |

## KEY CLEANING STEPS

- Converted currency strings to numeric; parsed release dates
- Dropped \$0 placeholder budgets and rows missing a studio
- Joined all 3 sources on movie title + release year
- Removed duplicate matches; engineered ROI, profit & intl. share

# Which Genres Deliver the Best Financial Return?



Genres with fewer than 15 films excluded. Median profit shown in notebook. n=1042 films.

FINDING

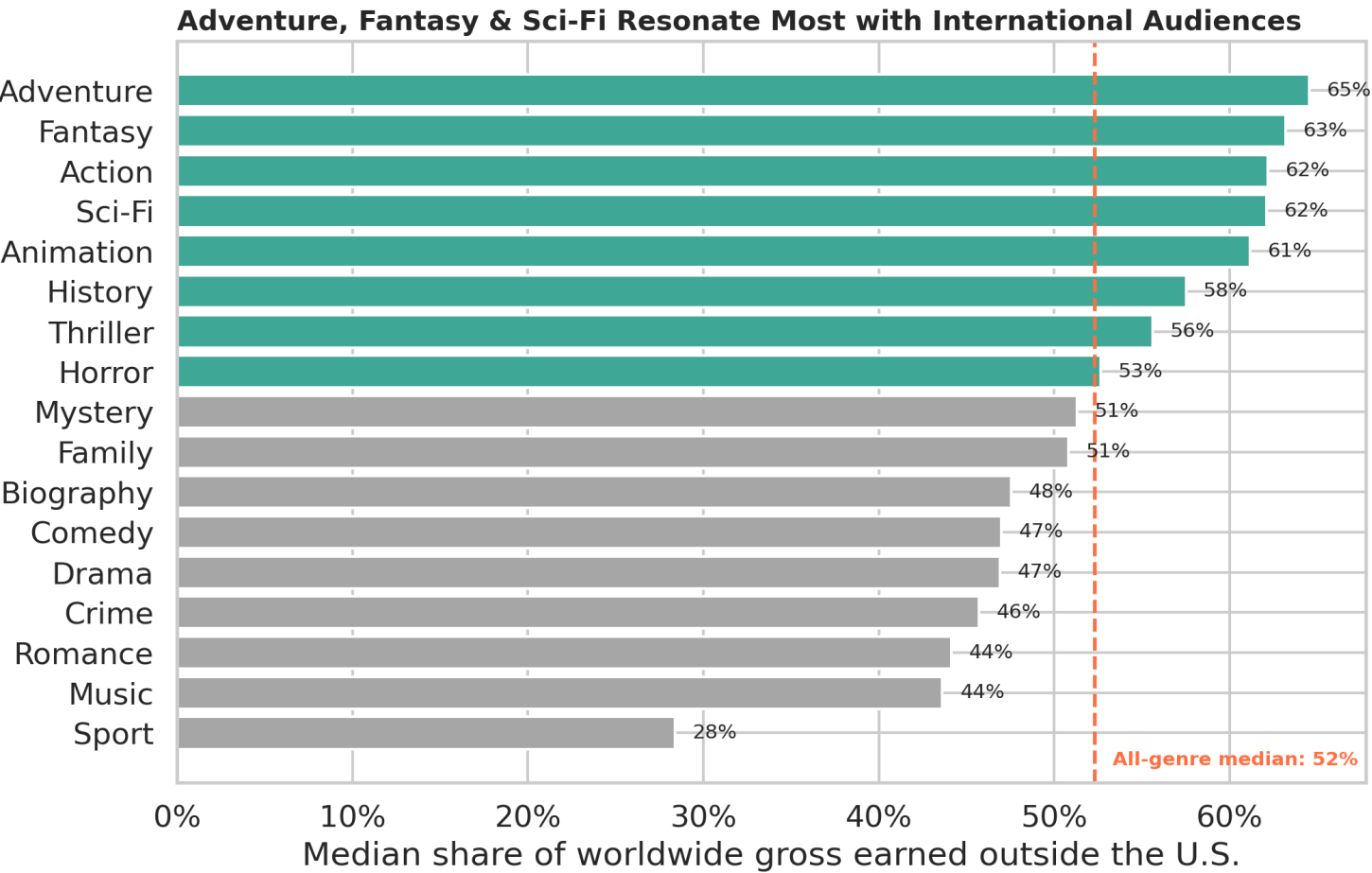
Mystery leads with a median ROI of 3.45x and median profit of \$56.0M. Horror follows at 2.90x ROI (\$42.3M median profit). Sci-Fi and Animation tie for third at 2.23x ROI, though Animation's median profit (\$237.8M) is far higher due to bigger budgets and grosses.

RECOMMENDATION

Prioritize Mystery & Horror

Both genres combine strong typical returns with modest average budgets — a lower-risk way to build an early, profitable track record.

# Which Genres Do Best Internationally?



Genres with fewer than 15 films excluded. Films missing foreign gross data excluded. n=939 films.

## FINDING

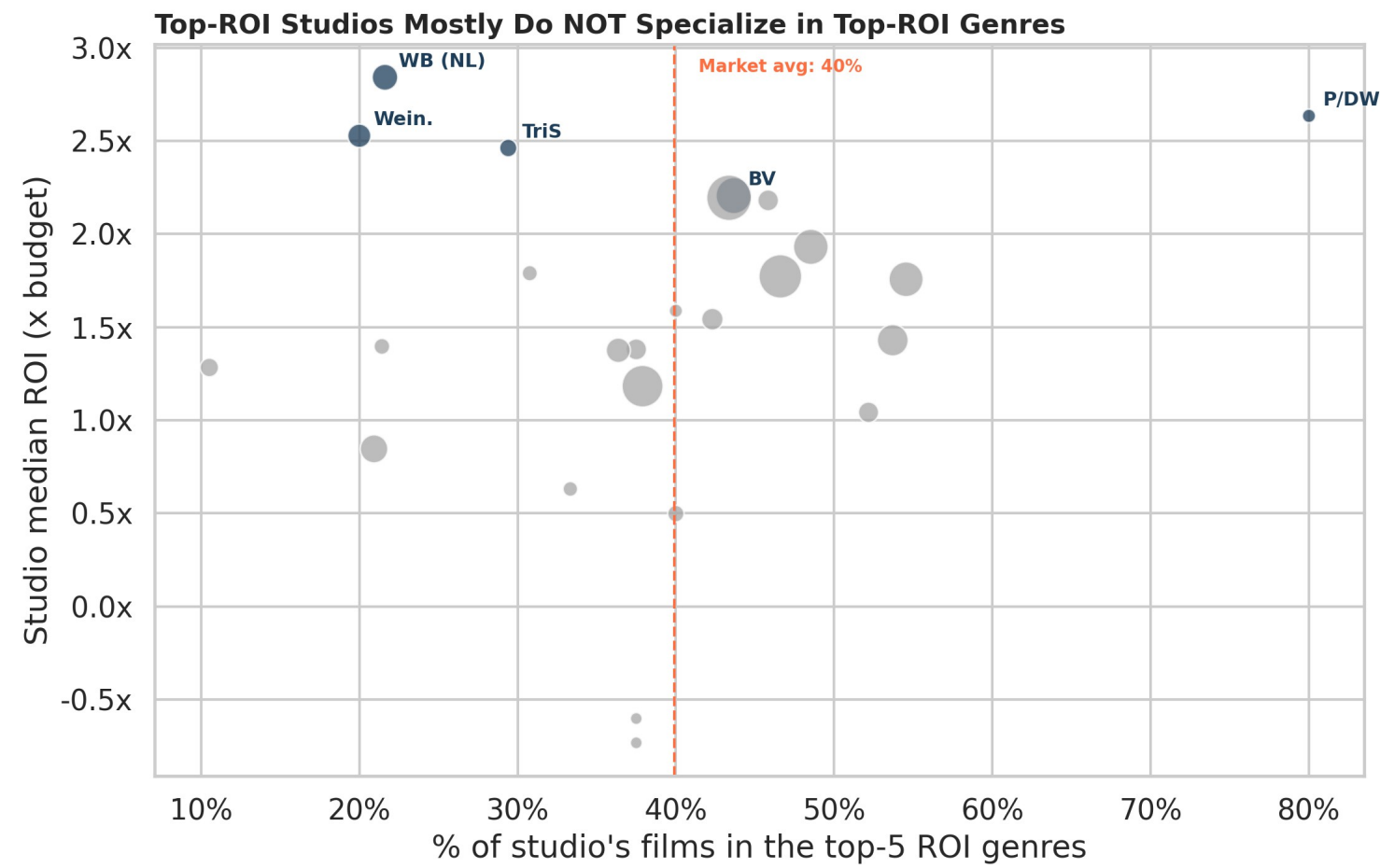
Adventure (65%), Fantasy (63%), Action (62%), Sci-Fi (62%), and Animation (61%) earn well over half their gross outside the U.S. — above the 52% all-genre median. Notably, Horror and Mystery (our top ROI genres) sit right around the median, meaning they don't especially over-index internationally.

## RECOMMENDATION

### Treat Intl. Reach as a Separate Lever

For global/franchise ambitions, look to Adventure, Fantasy, Sci-Fi & Animation — a different genre set than our top-ROI picks.

# Do Top Studios Align with Top Genres?



## FINDING

The top 5 studios by median ROI are New Line (2.84x), P/DW (2.63x), Weinstein (2.53x), TriStar (2.46x), and Disney/BV (2.21x). But only 2 of those 5 exceed the market-average share of films in our top-5 ROI genres — 3 of the 5 best studios succeeded largely outside those genres.

## RECOMMENDATION

### Benchmark Execution, Not Just Genre

Studio success and genre choice are only loosely linked. Study New Line & Weinstein's production and marketing playbook directly.

# Recommendations

*Our recommended strategy:*

01

FINANCIAL CORE

**Mystery & Horror films**

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3.45x / 2.90x median ROI — lower-risk, high-return

02

GLOBAL GROWTH

**Adventure, Sci-Fi, Animation**

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60%+ of gross earned outside the U.S.

03

BENCHMARKING

**Study New Line & Weinstein**

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Top ROI studios that succeed outside the top genres



## NEXT STEPS

# Where We Go From Here

1

### Build the interactive dashboard

Publish the Tableau dashboard so leadership can filter by genre and studio themselves.

2

### Model additional levers

Layer in release timing/season and marketing spend, which this dataset doesn't yet capture.

3

### Incorporate critic scores

Add Rotten Tomatoes critic ratings once a reliable join key is available, to add a quality dimension.

# Thank You

*Questions?*

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